



Gadget Disruption

HTC seems to be overconfident about leaving its mark. Follow the link to find out more <http://dgit.in/1a785u2>

Television Overtake

Netflix may be taking HBO for a ride with respect to subscribers <http://dgit.in/1cX61mU>

Desktop All-in-ones Test

HOW WE TESTED

Whenever we receive any products for review, we take a lot of care to ensure they're judged on a level playing field. For this, we created our own partition on their hard drives, installed our own copy of the 64-bit version of Windows 8 OS, ensure none of the key hardware drivers were missing, and of course perform a Windows update once before proceeding with our system benchmarks. The screens were kept at maximum brightness and so was the audio volume. Finally, we disconnected the all-in-ones from the Internet or any other local network to keep them completely isolated.

Benchmarking

We benchmarked the all-in-ones under High Performance mode (including other advanced settings which prevent hard drive idling, sleep, system hibernation, etc., that keep the machine in an always-on state) in the Power Settings of the Control Panel to ensure we stressed the machines enough. We ran through a whole gamut of Futuremark benchmarks, including PC Mark 8, 3D Mark, and Peacekeeper; not to mention Maxon's Cinebench to test both the system's CPU and GPU, respectively. All these

industry standard benchmarks do a very good job of running standard scripts to gauge a system's Web browsing, photo and video editing, casual gaming, and multimedia capabilities. We also took a look at PixPerAn and Lagom.nl's test parameters to ascertain the viewability aspects of the screen of all these all-in-one desktops – parameters that included text readability, contrast, colour gradient, black level and white saturation.

Real-world testing included browsing the Web, watching movies and listening to music – which pretty much all machines in here are capable of handling. We also watched high bit-rate Blu-ray rips in MKV format to judge each machine's HD movie playback and ran through a whole host of our audio test files to check the onboard sound quality at different volume levels. On products that came with a discrete GPU, we tried some gaming as well, just to see if they could handle it. As always, we scored these aspects of the products on a scale of 1 to 10.

Feature listing

After this the specs and features of every all-in-one desktop were listed and weighed. We

didn't assign points to core hardware components (since its impact is felt in our performance benchmarks, anyway), but scored products based on aspects like the number of connectivity ports, screen size, type of panel, whether they support touch-input or not, stereoscopic 3D, active shutter 3D glasses, etc. We also considered preloaded software including backup and restore apps, cloud syncing tools, webcam software, and any other uniquely interesting, non-bloatware programs as valuable additions to the product. Ultimately, the more features provided by a product the better, obviously, and that's exactly what we looked for.

Build and design

While design and appeal is a matter of immense personal taste and subjectivity, the choice of components and basic ergonomics, however, isn't. Desktops that had metal stands or exterior as opposed to plastic were graded higher, so were products that had a flexible orientation (tilt forward, backwards, conceal its stand to become a tablet, etc.) compared to rigid, unwholesome boxes. We also graded keyboard and mice here in terms of their overall usability.

know that consumers' tastes are evolving and improving – even while picking AIOs – and any brand that shortchanges them does so at their own risk, with the danger of being dropped off the customers' radars permanently. The all-in-one desktops we received this month for testing were all sleek and sexy in their own right, be it the most inexpensive sub-₹30k desktop or a rather large 27-inch desktop-tablet hybrid priced at over ₹1.3 lakhs.

We're glad to report that almost all AIOs now ship with a de facto wireless keyboard and mouse combo, keeping the cable clutter on your desk to a bare minimum. Also, one of your truly's perpetual dreams to see "portable" AIOs (or is it more appropriate to call them giant tablets?) featuring built-in bat-

teries is finally being realized. According to our scoring sheets, the bare minimum number of features available in any AIO sold now, compared to two years ago, has increased and improved. We got more products than what we featured in the pages here, and over 90 per cent of the products we tested were all good and highly recommendable. That's a huge improvement over 2011, the last time we did an all-in-one desktop comparison. The playing field was much smaller at the time and the quality of majority players not of the highest order.

Below ₹50,000

If you thought lower-priced products are *always* inferior to their higher-priced counterparts, you'll be pleasantly surprised to know that this

month's **Best Performer** – the HP Pavilion 21 – edges out the rest of the competition quite comfortably. The combination of a good processor paired with very good graphics running on a 7200 rpm drive supported ably by an adequate quantity of RAM is just too much for anyone to handle. The fact that it outperforms some of its higher-priced brethrens (a la the two 23-inch HP AIOs) is a strong testament to its unique build. What's surprising is that not only does the Pavilion 21 kick every other PC's collective derriere in terms of raw, benchmark scores, it also does a stellar job of passing our real-world tests with great aplomb – including stuff like watching 1080p video, better-than-average onboard speakers, and a vibrant Full HD display. We even did some casual

gaming on the thing, and you can get by on most of the latest games at medium settings. It doesn't stop there; the machine is quite petite, compact and well-built and its keyboard and mouse are great to work with as well. Having three years of warranty – which is the highest here – is another thing going for the HP Pavilion. Yes, it doesn't have a touch-enabled screen (how often will you touch your PC's screen, seriously?) and it can't be used as a TV out-of-the-box, but at its aggressive price, it more than justifies the purchase if you're looking for a solid, high-performing, space-saving PC alternative for your old and aging desktop.

Coming to the next best AIO in this price bracket, the Lenovo IdeaCentre C340 is also a very good machine,